

Web System Technologies

IT0049



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Module 7

Email Class

Objectives

- To describe how to send emails in a CodeIgniter application using SMTP
- To gain knowledge of how to Set Email Parameters
- To learn how to use the Email Class of CodeIgniter
- To use HTML layout as the email message body
- To describe how to send emails in a CodeIgniter application using SMTP
- To gain knowledge of how to Set Email Parameters
- To learn how to use the Email Class of CodeIgniter
- To use HTML layout as the email message body



Email Class Overview

Email Class

CodeIgniter's robust Email Class supports the following features:

- Multiple Protocols: Mail, Sendmail, and SMTP
- TLS and SSL Encryption for SMTP
- Multiple recipients, CC, and BCCs
- HTML or Plaintext email
- Attachments
- Word wrapping
- Priorities
- BCC Batch Mode
- Email Debugging tools



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Sending Email

Sending email is not only simple, but you can configure it on the fly or set your preferences in the **app/Config/Email.php** file.

Example:

```
<?php

$email = service('email');

$email->setFrom('your@example.com', 'Your Name');
$email->setTo('someone@example.com');
$email->setCC('another@another-example.com');
$email->setBCC('them@their-example.com');

$email->setSubject('Email Test');
$email->setMessage('Testing the email class.');
```

```
$email->send();
```

***This example assumes you are sending the email from one of your controllers.*

Setting Email Preferences

There are 21 different preferences available to tailor how your email messages are sent. You can either set them manually as described here, or automatically via preferences stored in your config file, described in [Email Preferences](#).

Setting Email Preferences by Passing an Array

Preferences are set by passing an array of preference values to the email initialize method. Here is an example of how you might set some preferences:

```
<?php

$config['protocol'] = 'sendmail';
$config['mailPath'] = '/usr/sbin/sendmail';
$config['charset'] = 'iso-8859-1';
$config['wordWrap'] = true;

$email->initialize($config);
```



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Setting Email Preferences

In a Config File

If you prefer not to set preferences using the above method, you can instead put them into the config file. Simply open the ***app/Config/Email.php*** file, and set your configs in the Email properties.

Then save the file and it will be used automatically. You will NOT need to use the ***\$email->initialize()*** method if you set your preferences in the config file.



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Email preferences

The following is a list of all the preferences that can be set when sending email.

Preference	Default Value	Options	Description
fromEmail			The email address to be set in the “from” header.
fromName			The name to be set in the “from” header.
userAgent	CodeIgniter		The “user agent”.
protocol	mail	mail, sendmail, or smtp	The mail sending protocol.
mailPath	/usr/sbin/sendmail		The server path to Sendmail.

Email preferences

Preference	Default Value	Options	Description
SMTPHost			SMTP Server Hostname.
SMTPUser			SMTP Username.
SMTPPass			SMTP Password.
SMTPPort	25		SMTP Port. (If set to 465, TLS will be used for the connection regardless of SMTPCrypto setting.)
SMTPTimeout	5		SMTP Timeout (in seconds).
SMTPKeepAlive	false	true/false	Enable persistent SMTP connections.



Email preferences

Preference	Default Value	Options	Description
SMTPCrypto	tls	tls, ssl, or empty string ("")	SMTP Encryption. Setting this to ssl will create a secure channel to the server using SSL, and tls will issue a STARTTLS command to the server. Connection on port 465 should set this to an empty string (""). See also SSL versus TLS for SMTP Protocol .
wordWrap	true	true/false	Enable word-wrap.
wrapChars	76		Character count to wrap at.

Email preferences

Preference	Default Value	Options	Description
mailType	text	text or html	Type of mail. If you send HTML email you must send it as a complete web page. Make sure you don't have any relative links or relative image paths otherwise they will not work.
charset	UTF-8		Character set (utf-8, iso-8859-1, etc.).
validate	true	true/false	Whether to validate the email address.

Email preferences

Preference	Default Value	Options	Description
priority	3	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	Email Priority. 1 = highest. 5 = lowest. 3 = normal.
CRLF	\r\n	\r\n, \n or \r	Newline character. (Use \r\n to comply with RFC 822).
newline	\r\n	\r\n, \n or \r	Newline character. (Use \r\n to comply with RFC 822).
BCCBatchMode	false	true/false	Enable BCC Batch Mode.
BCCBatchSize	200		Number of emails in each BCC batch.
DSN	false	true/false	Enable notify message from server.



Class Reference



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Class Reference

```
setFrom($from [, $name = " [, $returnPath = null ] ] )
```

- Parameters:**
- **\$from** (`string`) – "From" email address
 - **\$name** (`string`) – "From" display name
 - **\$returnPath** (`string`) – Optional email address to redirect undelivered email to
- Returns:** CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)
- Return type:** `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the email address and name of the person sending the email:

```
<?php  
$email->setFrom('you@example.com', 'Your Name');
```

You can also set a Return-Path, to help redirect undelivered mail:

```
<?php  
$email->setFrom('you@example.com', 'Your Name', 'returned_emails@example.com');
```



Class Reference

setReplyTo(\$replyto [, \$name = ""])

- Parameters:**
- **\$replyto** (`string`) – Email address for replies
 - **\$name** (`string`) – Display name for the reply-to email address

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the reply-to address. If the information is not provided the information in the `setFrom` method is used. Example:

```
<?php  
  
$email->setReplyTo('you@example.com', 'Your Name');
```



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Class Reference

setTo(\$to)

Parameters: • **\$to** (`mixed`) – Comma separated string or an array of email addresses

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the email address(es) of the recipient(s). Can be a single email, a comma separated list or an array:

```
<?php
$email->setTo('someone@example.com');
```

```
<?php
$email->setTo('one@example.com, two@example.com, three@example.com');
```

```
<?php
$email->setTo(['one@example.com', 'two@example.com', 'three@example.com']);
```



Class Reference

setCC(\$cc)

- Parameters:**
- **\$cc** (`mixed`) – Comma separated string or an array of email addresses
- Returns:** CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)
- Return type:** `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the CC email address(es). Just like the "to", can be a single email, a comma separated list or an array.



Class Reference

setBCC(\$bcc [, \$limit = "1"]) ⓘ

- Parameters:**
- **\$bcc** (`mixed`) – Comma separated string or an array of email addresses
 - **\$limit** (`int`) – Maximum number of emails to send per batch

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the BCC email address(es). Just like the `setTo()` method, can be a single email, a comma separated list or an array.

If `$limit` is set, "batch mode" will be enabled, which will send the emails to batches, with each batch not exceeding the specified `$limit`.



Class Reference

setSubject(\$subject)

Parameters: • **\$subject** (`string`) – Email subject line

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the email subject:

```
<?php  
  
$email->setSubject('This is my subject');
```



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Class Reference

`setMessage($body)`

Parameters: • `$body` (`string`) – Email message body

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the email message body:

```
<?php  
  
$email->setMessage('This is my message');
```



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Class Reference

setAltMessage(\$str)

Parameters: • **\$str** (`string`) – Alternative email message body

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Sets the alternative email message body:

```
<?php  
  
$email->setAltMessage('This is the alternative message');
```

This is an optional message string which can be used if you send HTML formatted email. It lets you specify an alternative message with no HTML formatting which is added to the header string for people who do not accept HTML email. If you do not set your own message CodeIgniter will extract the message from your HTML email and strip the tags.



Class Reference

setHeader(\$header, \$value)

- Parameters:**
- **\$header** (`string`) – Header name
 - **\$value** (`string`) – Header value
- Returns:** CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)
- Return type:** `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Appends additional headers to the email:

```
<?php  
  
$email->setHeader( 'Header1', 'Value1' );  
$email->setHeader( 'Header2', 'Value2' );
```



Class Reference

clear(\$clearAttachments = false)

Parameters: • **\$clearAttachments** (`bool`) – Whether or not to clear attachments

Returns: CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)

Return type: `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Initializes all the email variables to an empty state. This method is intended for use if you run the email sending method in a loop, permitting the data to be reset between cycles.

```
<?php

foreach ($list as $name => $address) {
    $email->clear();

    $email->setTo($address);
    $email->setFrom('your@example.com');
    $email->setSubject('Here is your info ' . $name);
    $email->setMessage('Hi ' . $name . ' Here is the info you requested.');
```

If you set the parameter to true any attachments will be cleared as well:

```
<?php

$email->clear(true);
```



Class Reference

send(\$autoClear = true)

Parameters: • **\$autoClear** (`bool`) – Whether to clear message data automatically

Returns: true on success, false on failure

Return type: `bool`

The email sending method. Returns boolean true or false based on success or failure, enabling it to be used conditionally:

```
<?php  
  
if (! $email->send()) {  
    // Generate error  
}
```

This method will automatically clear all parameters if the request was successful. To stop this behaviour pass false:

```
<?php  
  
if ($email->send(false)) {  
    // Parameters won't be cleared  
}
```



FEU ALABANG



FEU DILIMAN



FEU TECH

Technology Driven by Innovation

Class Reference

```
attach($filename [, $disposition = " ", $newname = null [, $mime = " " ] ] )
```

- Parameters:**
- **\$filename** (`string`) – File name
 - **\$disposition** (`string`) – 'disposition' of the attachment. Most email clients make their own decision regardless of the MIME specification used here.
<https://www.iana.org/assignments/cont-disp/cont-disp.xhtml>
 - **\$newname** (`string`) – Custom file name to use in the email
 - **\$mime** (`string`) – MIME type to use (useful for buffered data)
- Returns:** CodeIgniter\Email\Email instance (method chaining)
- Return type:** `CodeIgniter\Email\Email`

Enables you to send an attachment. Put the file path/name in the first parameter. For multiple attachments use the method multiple times. For example:

```
<?php  
  
$email->attach('/path/to/photo1.jpg');  
$email->attach('/path/to/photo2.jpg');  
$email->attach('/path/to/photo3.jpg');
```

To use the default disposition (attachment), leave the second parameter blank, otherwise use a custom disposition:

```
<?php  
  
$email->attach('image.jpg', 'inline');
```

You can also use a URL:

```
<?php  
  
$email->attach('http://example.com/filename.pdf');
```



Class Reference

setAttachmentCID(\$filename)

Parameters: • **\$filename** (`string`) – Existing attachment filename

Returns: Attachment Content-ID or false if not found

Return type: `string`

Sets and returns an attachment's Content-ID, which enables you to embed an inline (picture) attachment into HTML. First parameter must be the already attached file name.

```
<?php

$filename = '/img/photo1.jpg';
$email->attach($filename);

foreach ($list as $address) {
    $email->setTo($address);
    $cid = $email->setAttachmentCID($filename);
    $email->setMessage('');
    $email->send();
}
```



Class Reference

```
printDebugger($include = ['headers', 'subject', 'body'])
```

Parameters: • **\$include** (`array`) – Which parts of the message to print out

Returns: Formatted debug data

Return type: `string`

Returns a string containing any server messages, the email headers, and the email message. Useful for debugging.

You can optionally specify which parts of the message should be printed. Valid options are: **headers**, **subject**, **body**.

Example:

```
<?php

// You need to pass false while sending in order for the email data
// to not be cleared – if that happens, printDebugger() would have
// nothing to output.
$email->send( false );

// Will only print the email headers, excluding the message subject and body
$email->printDebugger( ['headers'] );
```

